Though Hindi is formally the first language of India, English and its alphabet are an almost inextricable part of the country's job market, advertising, and even the entertainment industry. The persistence of English has been good for India's growth, but its use is frustrating to many modern Indians who know full well it comes from an era of unfair colonialism. Efforts are being made by some to bolster the use of India's more historical languages, including Bengali, Konkani, and Marathi.

The caste system is still very much an ingrained part of life for the country's more than 1.3 billion residents. Concerted efforts have been made by the government, activist groups, and even religious sects, but the trenches dug by thousands of years of tradition are deep. In many cases, employers overlook the Brahmin candidates in an attempt to make up for the injustices of the past, and this only creates the opposite disparity. Still, on average, that Brahmin five percent of the population is more educated and better paid than the rest. Women are making a determined appearance in the workplace, however, and this is perhaps the positive message some employers and traditionalist families need to see to understand the benefits of letting go of some parts of the past.

The Republic of India maintains close ties with the United Kingdom but strives to develop itself once more as a land of unique resources and culture. Most citizens consider the ongoing relationship between India and the United Kingdom as positive. Many university students leave India to undertake their post-secondary studies in the UK, while Indian producers still sell spices and food items to the British who can't seem to get enough curry. The two nations interchange tourists, long-term immigrants, chefs, entrepreneurs, and much more, and that happy trade arrangement is only growing.

As for China's stolen delicacy, India remains the world's second-largest tea producer (behind China), growing 1.3 million metric tons of tea annually—that's about 1.4 million tons. What's more, they drink about 70 percent of that yield themselves, mostly as a chai mixture. Markedly different from Chinese or English tea preparations, Indian chai tea uses a blend of varied tea leaf species, brewed together with spices like cinnamon, cardamom, and cloves. When the tea is strong enough, it is sweetened delicately and finished off with a few careful drops of milk.

That fragrant, complex, and satisfying cup of chai tea is, perhaps, the perfect metaphor for a land that can take a thousand gods, billions of